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DEMOGRAPHIC AND SETTLEMENT HISTORY OF THE RUSSIAN CIVIL WAR ACROSS PRE-WAR TSARIST GOVERNORATES AND OBLASTS (1917AD - 1926AD).

A Regional Literature Review of Population and Settlement (1914AD - 1926AD).

11 November 2026 - Aust Kätzchen | austkaeztchen@confoederatio.org

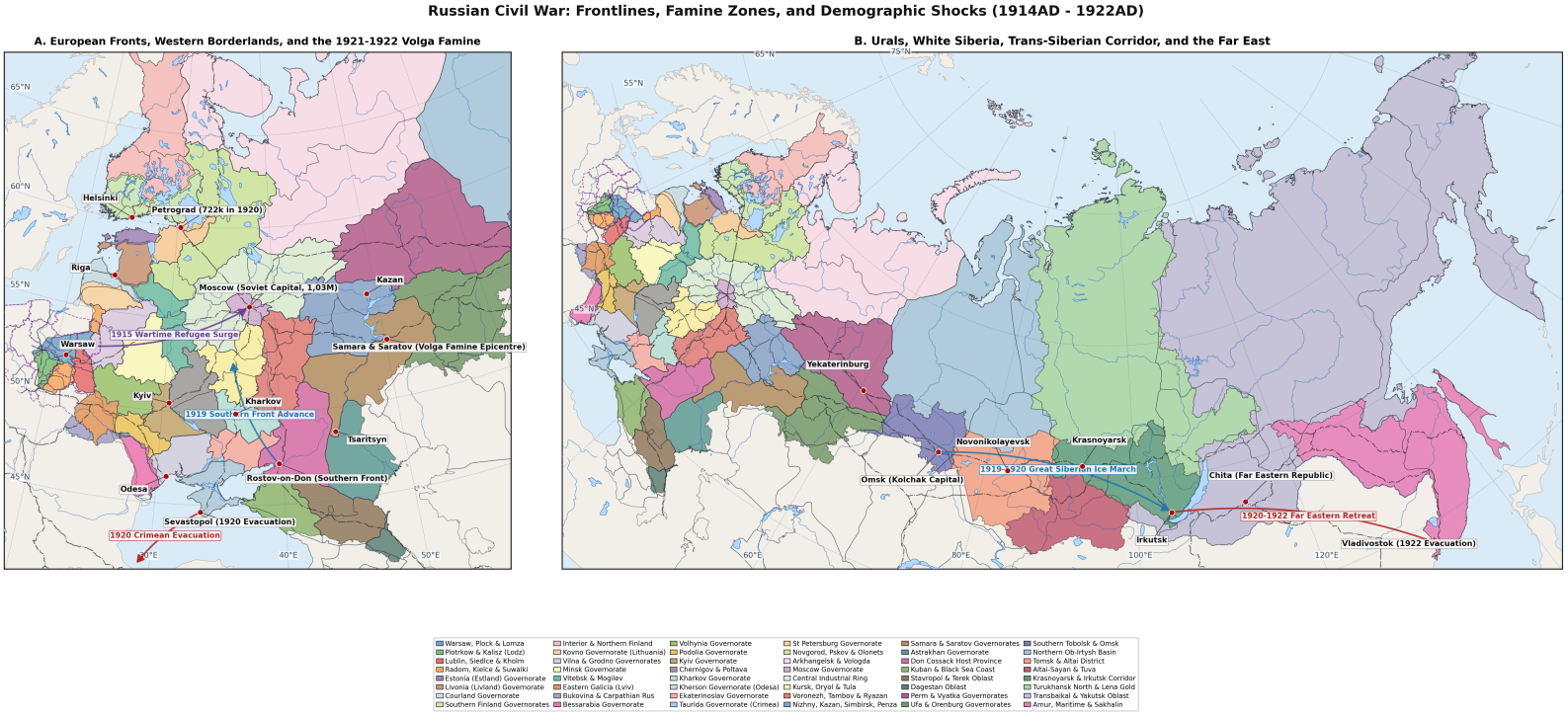


Figure 1. Pre-war Tsarist governorates, secession boundaries, famine zones and major cities during the Russian Civil War and NEP recovery (1914AD - 1926AD).

Abstract

Across the forty-eight pre-war Tsarist Governorates and Oblasts (18.607.231 km2 across 460.079 five-arcminute grid cells, excluding Central Asia and the Southern Caucasus), total population contracted from 167,94M (167,95M) in 1914AD to 165,38M (165,38M) at the revolutionary benchmark of 1917AD, fell steadily across the Civil War years (160,6M in 1918AD, 155,97M in 1919AD, 152,04M in 1920AD and 149,54M in 1921AD) to a famine trough of 148,66M (148,66M) in 1922AD - a net loss of 19,29M (-11,5% below 1914AD, or -16,72M and -10,1% below 1917AD, alongside roughly 12M-14M unborn children) - before rebounding under the New Economic Policy (*NEP*) and interwar agrarian reconstruction to 157,8M in 1924AD and 167,78M (167,78M) by December 1926AD [1][2][3][4] (archived PDF). Excluding the two Habsburg Carpatho-Galician regions (Regions 14-15) and Finland (Regions 8-9), the forty-four Tsarist

imperial provinces proper declined from 155,41M (1914AD) and 152,78M (1917AD) to 135,85M (1922AD) before recovering to 153,69M (1926AD).

Background

Reconstructing the demographic history of the Russian Civil War (1917-1926AD, anchored to a 1914AD pre-war baseline) on the fixed territorial denominator of the forty-eight pre-war Tsarist Governorates and Oblasts (including former Congress Poland, the three Baltic Governorates, the Grand Duchy of Finland, Lithuania, Bessarabia and the adjacent Carpatho-Galician borderlands of Eastern Galicia, Bukovina and Subcarpathian Rus) resolves the central accounting problem of early twentieth-century Eurasian demography [1][5][6][7]. Because the Russian Empire disintegrated between 1917AD and 1921AD into the Soviet republics and seven Central and Eastern European successor states, conventional demographic series bounded by post-1921AD Soviet borders conflate biological excess mortality with border changes, two-way wartime refugee streams and post-treaty repatriations [8][9][10][11]. Holding the forty-eight pre-war administrative units constant exposes the unbroken 1914-1922AD continuum of crisis - First World War mobilisation, the 1915AD Great Retreat (*biezenstwo*), the 1918AD Brest-Litovsk rupture and national wars of independence, multi-front Red-White-Green warfare, urban de-population under War Communism, pandemic typhus and Spanish influenza and the 1921-1922AD Povolzhye-Ural-Southern Ukrainian famine - before showing at the 1926AD splice how diplomatic treaties detached 37,84M inhabitants into interwar European states and transferred 4,94M across internal Kazakh, Tuvan and western district adjustments, leaving 125M inside the 17 December 1926AD All-Union Census core of the RSFSR, Ukrainian SSR and Belorussian SSR [12].

Methodology

Eight primary census and statistical collections anchor our forty-eight-region series. For the pre-revolutionary baseline and First World War displacement, the 1914AD TsSK Statistical Yearbooks and the 1917AD All-Russian Agricultural and Municipal Censuses record pre-war governorate populations and the 1917AD wartime redistribution of 6M-7M western refugees (*bezhentsy*) and garrisoned soldiers into central Russian, Ukrainian and Belarusian cities [8][13][14][15] (archived PDF). At the height of the Civil War, the 28 August 1920AD All-Russian Demographic-Occupational Census, conducted by Pavel Popov's Central Statistical Administration (*TsSU RSFSR*), enumerated accessible European and Siberian provinces at the nadir of War Communism urban depopulation [16][17].

Across the newly independent northwestern states, Finnish Official Vital and Census Statistics (SVT VI, 1917-1926AD) and the War Victims in Finland (1914-1922AD) Registry provide parish-level population counts across Finland's eight governorates (Regions 8-9), the December 1920AD national census (3,36M *de jure*; 3,11M present) and individual-level mortality records for the 1918AD Finnish Civil War [18][19][20] (archived PDF; archived PDF). South of the Gulf of Finland, the Baltic independence censuses (Latvia in 1920AD and 1925AD, Estonia in 1922AD and Lithuania in 1923AD) measure wartime evacuation losses and post-treaty optation returns across Estland, Livland, Courland, Latgale and Kovno in Regions 5-7, 10 and 13 [21][22][23][24][25] (archived PDF; archived PDF).

Along the western and southwestern frontier, the 30 September 1921AD First General Census of the Republic of Poland (GUS) enumerated Congress Poland (Regions 1-4), the Riga *Kresy Wschodnie* across Vilna, Grodno, western Minsk and western Volhynia (Regions 11-12 and 17) and Eastern Galicia (Region 14), supplemented by the 1919AD Civil Administration of the Eastern Lands (*ZCZW*) count [26][27][28] (archived PDF; archived PDF). Farther south, Czechoslovak (15 February 1921AD) and Romanian (1919-1926AD) enumerations anchor Subcarpathian Rus (6k in 1921AD), Bukovina (Region 15) and

Bessarabia (Region 16) [29][30][31] (archived PDF; archived PDF).

Within the Soviet republics, the 15 March 1923AD All-Union Urban Census captured early NEP municipal recovery across 1.925 Soviet cities and urban settlements immediately after the 1921-1922AD famine [32][33] (archived PDF). Finally, the 17 December 1926AD First All-Union Population Census and the 1926-1927AD Polar Census, published in 56 volumes under Vasily Mikhailovsky and Osip Kvitkin, provide rural and urban counts across all Soviet republics, ASSRs, AOs and northern indigenous territories [5][12].

Results

Regional Trajectories and the 1926AD Territorial Splice

Table 1 reports the benchmark population series (1914AD - 1926AD, in thousands) for all forty-eight pre-war Tsarist Governorates and Oblasts across the former empire, grouped into three macro-zones: the Western Imperial and Carpatho-Galician Borderlands (Regions 1-16, 1.022.140 km2), Ukraine and Novorossiya (Regions 17-24, 541.852 km2) and European Russia, the North Caucasus, the Urals, Siberia and the Far East (Regions 25-48, 17.043.239 km2). Figure 2 plots the divergence in timing and amplitude across eight regional theatres alongside stacked macro-regional volumes.

Tsarist Governorate/Oblast	1914	1917	1918	1919	1920	1921	1922	1924	1926
1. Warsaw, Plock & Lomza Governorates	5,05M	4,42M	4,35M	4,42M	4,48M	4,61M	4,74M	4,92M	5,11M
2. Piotrkow & Kalisz Governorates	3,32M	2,95M	2,89M	2,94M	2,98M	3,06M	3,15M	3,28M	3,41M
3. Lublin & Siedlce Governorates	2,68M	2,08M	2,12M	2,18M	2,21M	2,32M	2,43M	2,56M	2,68M
4. Radom, Kielce & Suwalki Governorates	2,6M	2,18M	2,16M	2,21M	2,25M	2,33M	2,41M	2,52M	2,63M
5. Estland Governorate	505k	515k	485k	465k	460k	470k	480k	490k	498k
6. Livland Governorate	1,56M	1,42M	1,28M	1,19M	1,15M	1,18M	1,23M	1,28M	1,33M
7. Courland Governorate	800k	380k	410k	440k	480k	520k	555k	590k	615k
8. Southern Finland Governorates	1,84M	1,89M	1,84M	1,85M	1,88M	1,9M	1,94M	2M	2,06M
9. Interior & Northern Finland Governorates	1,4M	1,43M	1,4M	1,42M	1,43M	1,45M	1,47M	1,51M	1,55M
10. Kovno Governorate	1,84M	1,32M	1,38M	1,43M	1,47M	1,53M	1,59M	1,67M	1,74M
11. Vilna & Grodno Governorates	3,94M	2,88M	2,84M	2,79M	2,76M	2,88M	3,01M	3,19M	3,36M
12. Minsk Governorate & Pripyat Polesia	3,04M	2,89M	2,82M	2,74M	2,68M	2,72M	2,79M	2,94M	3,11M
13. Vitebsk & Mogilev Governorates	4,02M	3,86M	3,78M	3,68M	3,61M	3,64M	3,71M	3,89M	4,08M
14. Austro-Hungarian Eastern Galicia	5,02M	4,45M	4,38M	4,31M	4,29M	4,39M	4,49M	4,68M	4,86M
15. Austro-Hungarian Bukovina	1,63M	1,5M	1,48M	1,46M	1,45M	1,48M	1,51M	1,57M	1,63M
16. Bessarabia Governorate	2,66M	2,62M	2,58M	2,54M	2,52M	2,55M	2,59M	2,68M	2,77M
Subtotal Regs 1-16: Western Borderlands	41,91M	36,78M	36,2M	36,06M	36,09M	37,04M	38,09M	39,77M	41,43M
17. Volhynia Governorate	4,12M	3,68M	3,61M	3,49M	3,41M	3,46M	3,54M	3,72M	3,91M
18. Podolia Governorate	3,98M	3,82M	3,75M	3,61M	3,51M	3,53M	3,58M	3,74M	3,92M
19. Kyiv Governorate	4,78M	4,84M	4,74M	4,56M	4,42M	4,44M	4,51M	4,74M	4,98M
20. Little Russian Governorates	6,65M	6,72M	6,64M	6,51M	6,38M	6,31M	6,26M	6,51M	6,81M
21. Kharkov Governorate	3,44M	3,51M	3,46M	3,38M	3,29M	3,23M	3,19M	3,36M	3,54M
22. Kherson Governorate	3,75M	3,78M	3,69M	3,56M	3,41M	3,21M	2,98M	3,21M	3,48M
23. Ekaterinoslav Governorate	3,45M	3,58M	3,46M	3,29M	3,14M	2,98M	2,81M	3,12M	3,46M
24. Taurida Governorate	2,06M	2,08M	2,02M	1,94M	1,79M	1,59M	1,41M	1,59M	1,79M
Subtotal Regs 17-24: Ukraine & Novorossiya	32,23M	32,01M	31,37M	30,34M	29,35M	28,75M	28,28M	29,99M	31,89M
25. Saint Petersburg Governorate	3,15M	3,38M	2,62M	2,08M	1,69M	1,79M	1,96M	2,31M	2,69M
26. Novgorod, Pskov & Olonets Governorates	3,58M	3,68M	3,58M	3,46M	3,38M	3,42M	3,48M	3,64M	3,81M
27. Arkhangelsk & Vologda Governorates	2,22M	2,28M	2,23M	2,17M	2,13M	2,14M	2,17M	2,28M	2,39M

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Tsarist Governorate/Oblast	1914	1917	1918	1919	1920	1921	1922	1924	1926
28. Moscow Governorate	3,56M	3,82M	3,12M	2,78M	2,59M	2,76M	3,02M	3,58M	4,18M
29. Central Industrial Ring	11,52M	11,88M	11,42M	11,08M	10,82M	10,91M	11,08M	11,58M	12,12M
30. Western Central Black-Earth Governorates	7,98M	8,18M	7,98M	7,76M	7,56M	7,42M	7,36M	7,74M	8,18M
31. Eastern Central Black-Earth Governorates	9,22M	9,45M	9,21M	8,96M	8,71M	8,46M	8,34M	8,82M	9,38M
32. Middle Volga Governorates	8,35M	8,55M	8,28M	8,06M	7,86M	7,22M	6,78M	7,18M	7,64M
33. Samara & Saratov Governorates	6,88M	7,12M	6,98M	6,79M	6,58M	5,78M	5,18M	5,58M	6,02M
34. Astrakhan Governorate	1,38M	1,41M	1,36M	1,29M	1,22M	1,12M	1,05M	1,14M	1,24M
35. Province of the Don Cossack Host	3,88M	3,94M	3,81M	3,61M	3,38M	3,21M	3,09M	3,34M	3,62M
36. Kuban Oblast & Black Sea Governorate	3,06M	3,12M	3,04M	2,91M	2,74M	2,59M	2,49M	2,72M	2,98M
37. Stavropol Governorate & Terek Oblast	2,61M	2,65M	2,58M	2,48M	2,37M	2,29M	2,22M	2,39M	2,58M
38. Dagestan Oblast	715k	725k	695k	665k	645k	635k	620k	665k	710k
39. Perm & Vyatka Governorates	7,88M	8,04M	7,78M	7,49M	7,28M	6,98M	6,76M	7,16M	7,62M
40. Ufa & Orenburg Governorates	5,35M	5,48M	5,36M	5,16M	4,98M	4,38M	3,96M	4,29M	4,66M
41. West Siberian Trans-Siberian Belt	3,18M	3,32M	3,34M	3,26M	3,21M	3,17M	3,16M	3,42M	3,72M
42. Ob-Irtysh River Trail & Polar Tundra	505k	520k	515k	505k	495k	490k	495k	520k	550k
43. Tomsk Railway Trunk	3,98M	4,18M	4,24M	4,19M	4,15M	4,19M	4,25M	4,56M	4,92M
44. Altai-Sayan Highlands	565k	575k	570k	560k	555k	560k	570k	600k	635k
45. Central Siberian Trans-Siberian Corridor	1,54M	1,56M	1,58M	1,56M	1,55M	1,57M	1,59M	1,72M	1,85M
46. Yenisei-Turukhansk Polar North & Bodaibo Lena Goldfields	270k	265k	260k	255k	250k	250k	250k	260k	270k
47. Transbaikal Oblast	1,29M	1,3M	1,29M	1,27M	1,25M	1,24M	1,25M	1,31M	1,39M
48. Priamurye Governor-Generalship	1,14M	1,15M	1,18M	1,21M	1,21M	1,18M	1,16M	1,25M	1,3M
Subtotal Regs 25-48: Russia, Caucasus & Siberia	93,81M	96,58M	93,03M	89,56M	86,6M	83,75M	82,29M	88,05M	94,46M
Grand Total (All 48 Tsarist Regions)	167,94M	165,38M	160,6M	155,97M	152,04M	149,54M	148,66M	157,8M	167,78M

Table 1. Regional population trajectories across all forty-eight pre-war Tsarist governorates and oblasts in thousands (1914AD - 1926AD).

Holding pre-war boundaries fixed reveals a two-phase spatial inversion between the western borderlands and the Russian interior. During the first phase of mobilisation and the Great Retreat (1914-1917AD), Regions 1-16 lost 5,12M inhabitants (41,91M to 36,78M, -12,2%) as Tsarist armies forcibly evacuated or triggered flight from Courland, Kovno, Grodno, Vilna, Congress Poland and Volhynia, while Austro-Russian combat displaced hundreds of thousands in Eastern Galicia [8][34]. Conversely, Regions 25-48 gained +2,77M (93,81M to 96,58M, +3%) as western refugees, evacuated Baltic and Polish factory workers and rear garrisons crowded into Petrograd, Moscow, the Central Industrial Ring, the Middle and Lower Volga and the Trans-Siberian corridor.

During the second phase of Civil War, urban hollowing, epidemics and famine (1917-1922AD), interior Russia and Ukraine plunged into multi-front warfare and the 1921-1922AD harvest failure. Regions 25-48 suffered a net contraction of -14,29M (96,58M down to 82,29M in 1922AD, -14,8%) and Ukraine (Regions 17-24) lost -3,73M (32,01M down to 28,28M, -11,7%), compounded by the westward return of Polish, Baltic and Lithuanian evacuees after the 1918-1921AD peace treaties (with Regions 1-16 reaching a low of 36,06M in 1919AD before climbing to 38,09M by 1922AD and 41,43M by 1926AD).

At the December 1926AD terminal splice, Table 2 and Figure 3B reconcile the 167,78M population of the

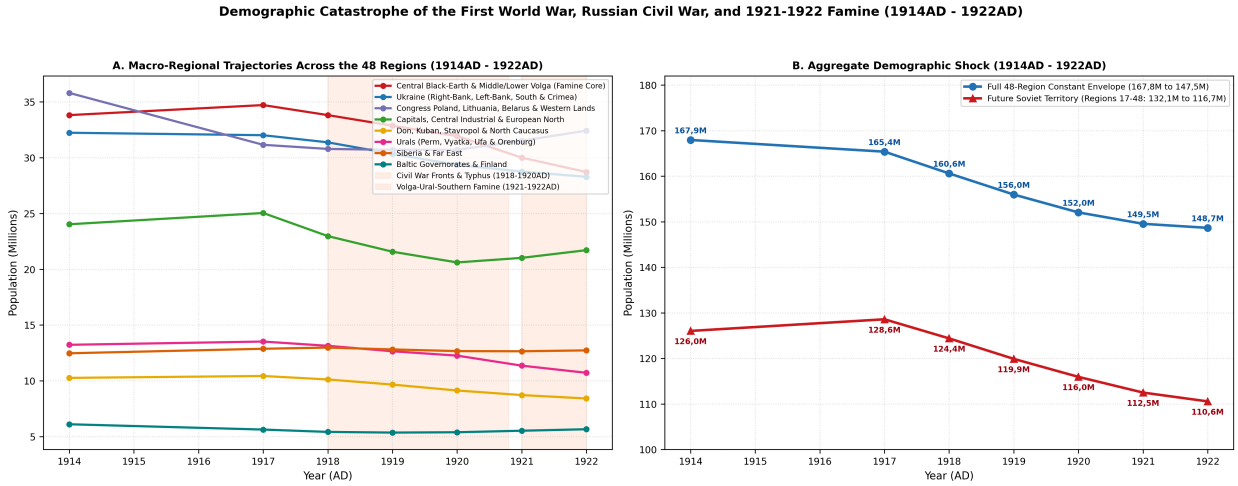


Figure 2. Indexed regional population trajectories (1914AD = 100, Panel A) and stacked macro-regional totals in millions across the Civil War (1914AD - 1926AD, Panel B).

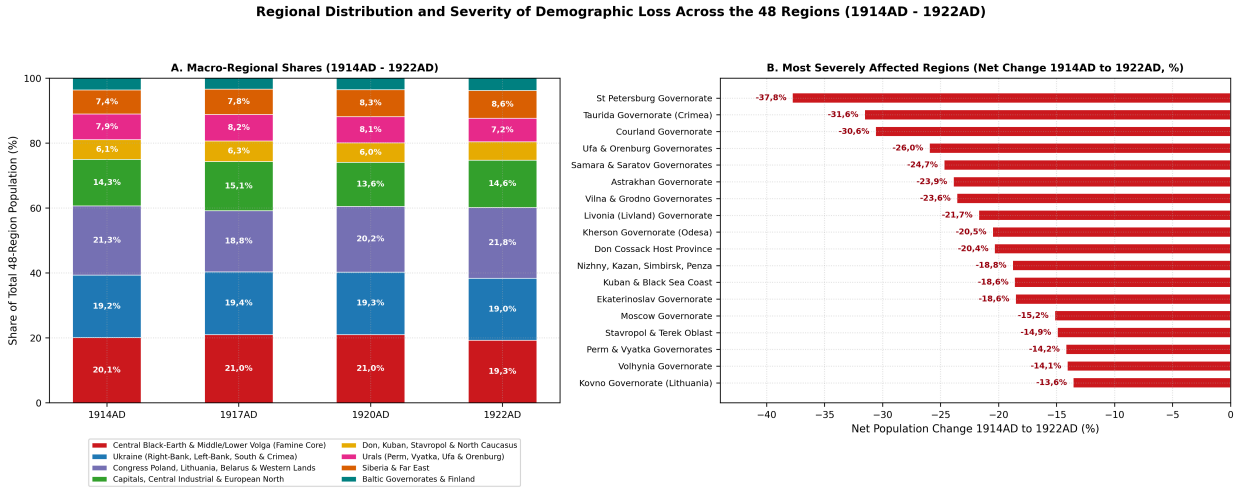


Figure 3. Peak-to-trough regional population losses during the Civil War (Panel A) and the 1926AD population distribution across successor states and the USSR (Panel B).

forty-eight pre-war Tsarist regions with interwar state boundaries and the subsequent interwar and wartime Soviet series (145,07M in 1926AD on post-1945AD USSR borders). Diplomatic treaties between 1917AD and 1921AD placed 37,84M inhabitants (22,6% of the 1926AD total) inside seven sovereign Central and Eastern European states (Second Polish Republic 24,61M, Kingdom of Romania 3,73M, Republic of Finland 3,6M, Republic of Lithuania 2,25M, Republic of Latvia 1,86M, Republic of Estonia 1,11M and Czechoslovakia 670k). Internal Soviet boundary realignments transferred 2,54M steppe inhabitants of Bukey (Astrakhan), southern Orenburg and southern Omsk uezds into the Kazakh ASSR (tracked in the Central Asian regional series), 70k into independent Tannu-Tuva (Uriankhai) and 2,33M across western district adjustments, yielding 125M on the 1926AD European and Siberian Soviet core (RSFSR and Karelia 92,41M, Ukrainian SSR and Crimea 27,75M and Eastern Belorussian SSR 4,84M). Adding back the 20,07M 1926AD inhabitants of the western territories later annexed by the USSR in 1939-1945AD (Estonia, Latvia,

Lithuania, Kaliningrad, Western Belarus, Western Ukraine, Northern Bukovina, Subcarpathia and Moldavia) reproduces the 145,07M 1926AD baseline on post-1945AD Soviet borders.

1926AD Territorial Component/Successor Polity	Treaty/Instrument	1926AD Pop.	Share
RSFSR European, Caucasian, Ural & Siberian Core (incl. Karelia)	1922AD USSR Treaty/ 1926AD Census	92,41M	55,1%
Ukrainian SSR & Crimean ASSR (1926AD All-Union Census Borders)	1922AD USSR Treaty/ 1926AD Census	27,75M	16,5%
Belorussian SSR (1926AD Enlarged Eastern Borders: Minsk, Vitebsk, Mogilev, Gomel)	1924AD & 1926AD BSSR Enlargements	4,84M	2,9%
Subtotal A: 1926AD All-Union Soviet Census Core	17 Dec 1926AD All-Union Census	125M	74,5%
Second Polish Republic (Congress Poland 13,83M + Riga Kresy 5,92M + E. Galicia 4,86M)	18 Mar 1921AD Riga/ 1923AD Ambass.	24,61M	14,7%
Kingdom of Romania (Bessarabia 2,77M + Bukovina 960k)	Apr/Nov 1918AD Union Acts	3,73M	2,2%
Republic of Finland (14 Oct 1920AD Treaty of Tartu Borders)	14 Oct 1920AD Treaty of Tartu	3,6M	2,1%
Republic of Lithuania (12 Jul 1920AD Moscow Treaty + Klaipeda; excl. Polish Wilno)	12 Jul 1920AD Moscow Treaty	2,25M	1,3%
Republic of Latvia (11 Aug 1920AD Treaty of Riga: Courland, Vidzeme & Latgale)	11 Aug 1920AD Treaty of Riga	1,86M	1,1%
Republic of Estonia (2 Feb 1920AD Treaty of Tartu, incl. Narva & Pechory)	2 Feb 1920AD Treaty of Tartu	1,11M	0,7%
Czechoslovak Republic (Subcarpathian Rus/ Podkarpatska Rus, Trianon 1920AD)	1919AD St-Germain/ 1920AD Trianon	670k	0,4%
Subtotal B: Detached into Seven Interwar Central-Eastern European States	1918-1923AD Interwar Settlement	37,84M	22,6%
Transferred to Kazakh ASSR (Bukey, Orenburg & S. Omsk Steppe Uezds) & Tannu-Tuva (70k)	1920-1925AD Kirghiz/ Kazakh ASSR	2,61M	1,6%
Net Western Frontier & Governorate-to-Okrug Boundary Realignments	1920-1926AD Admin. Delimitation	2,33M	1,4%
Grand Total on Fixed 48-Region Tsarist Footprint (1926AD)	48 Pre-War Tsarist Regions	167,78M	100%
Reconciliation to Post-1945AD USSR Borders (1926AD): Subtotal A (125M) + 1939-45AD Annexations (+20,07M)	Post-1945AD USSR Splice	145,07M	-

Table 2. Reconciliation of the 48 pre-war Tsarist regions in 1926AD (167,78M) with interwar successor states and the 1926AD USSR Census.

Western Secession, Independence Wars and Refugee Repatriation

Former Congress Poland

Across the ten Vistula Governorates of former Congress Poland (116.848 km2; Regions 1-4), pre-war population fell by -2,02M (-14,8%) between 1914AD (13,65M) and 1917AD (11,63M, reaching a low of 11,52M in 1918AD) under the combined shock of August 1914AD frontier combat (including the German artillery destruction of Kalisz, halving the city from 65,4k to 29k), the summer 1915AD Russian Great Retreat (*biezenstwo*) that swept over 1,2M inhabitants eastward, particularly from Lublin, Siedlce, Kholm, Lomza and Suwalki (with Region 3 dropping -22,4% from 2,68M to 2,08M), and Central Powers raw-material blockades and labour requisitions [8][27] (archived PDF). Deprived of Russian cotton markets and British-American raw cotton, textile Lodz (Region 2) contracted from 477,9k (1914AD) to 342k (1917AD), while Warsaw (Region 1) dipped from 884,5k to 758k. Following the rebirth of the Second Polish

Republic (November 1918AD) and the 1919-1920AD Polish-Soviet War - which climaxed in Tukhachevsky's August 1920AD drive to the gates of Warsaw and high typhus/dysentery mortality in mutual prisoner-of-war camps [35] (archived PDF) - the 30 September 1921AD First Polish Census recorded 12,32M across Regions 1-4 (Warsaw 936,7k, Lodz 452k and Lublin 94,4k) [26]. Organised repatriation trains under Article VII of the 18 March 1921AD Treaty of Riga returned over 1,1M civilian refugees and former POWs from Soviet Russia between 1921AD and 1924AD, lifting Congress Poland above its pre-war level to 13,83M by 1926AD (Warsaw 1,03M and Lodz 561,6k) [9].

Estland, Livland and Courland

Nowhere in the Russian Empire was First World War evacuation and industrial dismantling deeper than in Courland (Region 7, 27.588 km2) and southern Livland (Region 6, 54.235 km2). When the German *Niemen Army* invaded Courland in spring-summer 1915AD, Tsarist military authorities and Latvian relief committees evacuated more than half the rural peasantry alongside Jewish communities, reducing Courland by -52,5% from 800k (1914AD) to 380k (1917AD; Libau/Liepaja fell from 90,7k to 43,2k, Mitau/Jelgava from 45,7k to 21,5k and Windau/Ventspils from 28,8k to 12,4k) [22][24] (archived PDF). Between 1915AD and 1917AD, Imperial authorities evacuated 395 factories and roughly 300.000 skilled metal, rubber (*Provodnik*) and electrical workers with their families from Riga to Moscow, Petrograd, Kharkov and Ekaterinoslav; tens of thousands of displaced Latvian workers and farmhands formed the Latvian Riflemen (*Latviesu strelnieki*), who subsequently served as a core force in the early Red Army. Following the 1918-1920AD Estonian and Latvian Wars of Independence - encompassing Soviet Latvian rule under Peteris Stucka, Baltic German *Landeswehr* fighting at Wenden/Cesis (June 1919AD) and Pavel Bermondt-Avalov's autumn 1919AD assault on Riga and burning of Mitau - the June 1920AD Latvian Census recorded Riga at just 185.137 (-64,2% below its 517.522 pre-war peak) [22]. Under the Peace Treaties of Tartu (2 February 1920AD with Estonia) and Riga (11 August 1920AD with Latvia), roughly 220.000 Latvian and 38.000 Estonian optants and refugees returned from Soviet Russia; by the 1922AD Estonian Census and 1925AD Latvian Census, Estland (Region 5) stood at 480k (498k in 1926AD; Tallinn reached 122,4k after shedding its 1917AD naval-fortress garrison peak of 159k), Livland reached 1,33M (1926AD; Riga stood at 337,7k in 1925AD and 339k in 1926AD, and Tartu at 50,3k in 1922AD) and Courland recovered partially to 615k (-23,1% below 1914AD) [21][22].

Southern and Northern Finland

Spared direct Eastern Front combat during 1914-1917AD, Southern Finland (Region 8, covering Nyland, Abo-Bjorneborg, Tavastehus and Vyborg across 114.315 km2) and Interior and Northern Finland (Region 9, covering Vasa, Kuopio, Sankt-Michel and Uleaborg across 263.819 km2) grew from 3,24M (1914AD) to 3,32M (1917AD) on Russian fortification employment before plunging into the brief, intensely lethal Finnish Civil War (27 January-15 May 1918AD) shortly after independence [36][37]. Industrial Red Guards controlled the southern urban triangle (Helsingfors, Tammerfors/Tampere, Kotka and Viipuri), while General Carl Gustaf Emil Mannerheim's White Senate mobilised Ostrobothnian and Karelian yeomanry from its provisional capital at Vasa and headquarters at Sankt-Michel. Following the April 1918AD urban siege of Tammerfors, German Baltic Sea Division landings at Hanko and Helsingfors and the capture of Viipuri, the Finnish National Archives *War Victims in Finland (1914-1922AD)* database documents 36.640 recorded war-related deaths (estimated total 37.000-38.500, over 1,1% of the national population in four months), comprising ~9.600 combat deaths, ~1.650 victims of Red Terror, ~8.400-10.000 victims of summary White field executions and ~12.500-13.500 Red prisoners out of ~80.000 internees who perished between June and September 1918AD from acute starvation, dysentery and Spanish influenza in overcrowded prison camps at Tammisaari (Ekenas), Hameenlinna (Tavastehus), Hennala (Lahti), Suomenlinna and Viipuri [19][20] (archived PDF; archived PDF). An additional 10.000-12.000 Red Finns fled across the Karelian Isthmus into Petrograd and Soviet Karelia (where Edvard Gylling organised the

1920AD Karelian Labour Commune), while 1918-1919AD Spanish influenza claimed ~20.000 civilian lives across Finland, depressing the combined population to 3,25M in 1918AD (1,84M in Region 8 and 1,41M in Region 9) before steady peacetime recovery carried Finland to 3,31M in 1920AD and 3,6M by 1926AD (Helsingfors 215,8k, Abo/Turku 61,8k, Tammerfors 52,4k and Viipuri 51,5k) [18].

Lithuania and Belarus

Across the four Northwestern Krai provinces (304.761 km2; Regions 10-13), 1915AD Tsarist scorched-earth evacuations and three years of German *Ober Ost* requisitions (1915-1918AD) cut Kovno Governorate (Region 10) by -28,3% (1,84M to 1,32M) and Vilna and Grodno Governorates (Region 11) by -26,9% (3,94M to 2,88M, sliding further to 2,76M in 1920AD during four-way Polish-Lithuanian-Bolshevik fighting, while Brest-Litovsk dropped from 57,4k to 16,5k in 1917AD) [8][34]. After General Lucjan Zeligowski's October 1920AD mutiny detached Vilna/Wilno (204,3k in 1914AD to 128,5k in 1919AD to 178k in 1926AD) into Central Lithuania and subsequently Poland (1922AD), Kaunas (Kovno) served as the provisional capital of interwar Lithuania, surging from an Ober Ost low of 42k (1917AD) to 92,4k in the September 1923AD Lithuanian Census (94,4k in 1926AD) as ~250.000-300.000 Lithuanian refugees returned from interior Russia [23][25][34] (archived PDF). In Belarus (Region 12 covering Minsk and Region 13 covering Vitebsk and Mogilev), 1919-1920AD Polish-Soviet fronts, Bulak-Balakhovich's Polesian raids and typhus reduced Minsk Governorate from 3,04M (1914AD) to 2,68M (1920AD) and Vitebsk-Mogilev from 4,02M to 3,61M (with Dvinsk/Daugavpils falling from 112,8k to 31,5k by 1920AD when Vitebsk's three Latgalian uezds joined Latvia). The 18 March 1921AD Treaty of Riga partitioned Belarus along the Polesian-Neman corridor [28] (archived PDF): western Minsk (Pinsk, Baranovichi and Nowogrodek) and Grodno-Vilna entered Poland, while Soviet eastern Minsk formed the Belorussian SSR, enlarged in March 1924AD and December 1926AD with Vitebsk, Mogilev and Gomel uezds (4,98M in the 1926AD census; Minsk 131,8k, Vitebsk 98,9k and Gomel 86,4k) [38][39] (archived PDF; archived PDF).

Eastern Galicia, Bukovina, Subcarpathia and Bessarabia

In former Austro-Hungarian Eastern Galicia (Region 14, 46.070 km2), repeated 1914-1917AD Russian-Austrian offensives cut population from 5,02M to 4,45M (1917AD), and Habsburg collapse immediately ignited the November 1918-July 1919AD Polish-Ukrainian War between the West Ukrainian People's Republic (*ZUNR*) and the Polish Republic over Lviv/Lwow (marked by the three-day November 1918AD Lviv pogrom) and the Drohobych-Boryslav oil basin, followed in summer 1920AD by Semyon Budyonny's First Cavalry Army sweep (with Region 14 reaching a low of 4,29M in 1920AD before recovering via the 1921AD Polish Census count of 4,39M to 4,86M in 1926AD) [26][40][41] (archived PDF; archived PDF). Across Region 15 (24.487 km2; 1,63M in 1914AD to 1,45M in 1920AD to 1,63M in 1926AD), Bukovina (Czernowitz 102,8k in 1926AD) united with Romania in November 1918AD, while Subcarpathian Rus (Uzhhorod and Mukachevo) joined Czechoslovakia under the 1919AD Treaty of Saint-Germain and 1920AD Treaty of Trianon (604,6k in the February 1921AD Czechoslovak Census) [29]. In Bessarabia Governorate (Region 16, 47.379 km2), Romanian military intervention (January 1918AD) and the *Sfatul Tarii* union vote (27 March/9 April 1918AD) severed the province from Odessa and the Dniester grain trade, sealing river bridges while triggering cross-Dniester refugee flight and three major anti-Romanian peasant and Bolshevik-backed insurrections - the Khotyn Uprising (January 1919AD, sending ~50.000 refugees fleeing across the Dniester into Podolia), the Bender Uprising (May 1919AD) and the Tatarbunary Uprising (September 1924AD) in southern Budjak - depressing Bessarabia from 2,66M (1914AD) to 2,52M (1920AD) before rural natural increase restored 2,77M by 1926AD (Kishinev declining from 128,7k pre-war to 115k in 1926AD), while Moscow established the rival Moldavian ASSR (October 1924AD, first capital Balta) on the Ukrainian left bank [30][31][42][43] (archived PDF; archived PDF; archived PDF).

Ukraine, the Russian Interior, the 1921-1922AD Famine and Siberia

Ukraine and the Southern Steppe

Ukraine (Regions 17-24, 541.852 km2; 32,23M in 1914AD and 32,01M in 1917AD) was the most contested battlefield of the Civil War: Kyiv (644k in 1917AD to 366,4k in 1920AD) changed hands more than a dozen times among the Central Rada, Pavlo Skoropadsky's German-backed Hetmanate, Symon Petliura's UNR Directory, the Red Army, Anton Denikin's Volunteer Army and the May 1920AD Polish-Ukrainian expedition [44]. Across Right-Bank Ukraine (Region 17 covering Volhynia, Region 18 covering Podolia and Region 19 covering Kyiv), 1918-1920AD brought the worst wave of anti-Jewish violence prior to the Shoah: over 1.300 documented pogroms perpetrated by insurgent *atamans* (Grigoriev, Zeleny and Struk), UNR Directory units, Denikin's White regiments and retreating cavalry killed 100.000-150.000 Jews - with single-week massacres at Proskurov (February 1919AD), Fastov (September 1919AD), Felshtin, Bila Tserkva, Uman, Cherkassy and Berdichev - and displaced over 500.000 survivors from ruined shtetls into larger cities or emigration [45][46][47].

Across the southern Ukrainian steppe (Region 22 covering Kherson, Region 23 covering Ekaterinoslav and Region 24 covering Taurida), Nestor Makhno's Revolutionary Insurgent Army centred on Huliaipole (Ekaterinoslav), Denikin's 1919AD Moscow offensive and Baron Pyotr Wrangel's 1920AD Northern Taurida campaign devastated rail junctions and coal pits (Yuzovka, Lugansk, Krivoy Rog and Aleksandrovsk). In mid-November 1920AD, after the Red Army stormed the Perekop Isthmus, Wrangel evacuated 145.693 soldiers and civilians on 126 vessels from Sevastopol, Yalta, Feodosiya, Evpatoriya and Kerch to Constantinople, immediately followed by Bela Kun and Rozaliya Zemlyachka's Red Terror in Crimea (50.000-60.000 executed) [7][48] (archived PDF). Severe 1921-1922AD drought together with continued Soviet grain shipments from southern Ukraine to northern Russia then triggered the Southern Ukrainian and Crimean Famine (1921-1923AD), killing 300.000-500.000 across Zaporizhzhia, Ekaterinoslav, Nikolaev, Odessa (630k in 1914AD down -55,2% to 282k in 1922AD) and 100.000 in Crimea (disproportionately striking Crimean Tatar mountain and coastal villages within the newly created October 1921AD Crimean ASSR), driving Taurida down -32,2% (2,08M to 1,41M), Ekaterinoslav down -21,5% (3,58M to 2,81M) and Kherson down -21,2% (3,78M to 2,98M) before NEP recovery carried Regions 17-24 back to 31,89M in 1926AD (with Kharkov, the first UkSSR capital from 1919AD to 1934AD, surging to 417,3k) [44][49] (archived PDF).

Petrograd, Moscow and the Central Black-Earth Belt

Figure 4 illustrates the steep urban contraction under War Communism documented by the August 1920AD census [16][17]. Cut off from Ukrainian coal, Baku oil and Siberian grain, and stripped of capital Ministries after Lenin relocated the Soviet government to Moscow in March 1918AD, Petrograd (Region 25, Saint Petersburg Governorate) lost -70,2% of its municipal population in three years - plunging from 2,42M (1917AD) to 1,47M (June 1918AD), 900k (1919AD, amid Nikolai Yudenich's Northwestern Army advance to Pulkovo Heights) and 722,2k (August 1920AD), pulling Saint Petersburg Governorate down -50% (3,38M to 1,69M, compounded by the March 1921AD suppression of the Kronstadt naval garrison and transfer of Narva to Estonia). Moscow (Region 28) fell -49,1% from 2,02M (September 1917AD) to 1,03M (August 1920AD, governorate 3,82M to 2,59M), while textile Ivanovo-Voznesensk (Region 29) dropped -60,4% (146k to 57,8k) as workers fled to native villages with hand-carts (*meshochniki*) [17][50] (archived PDF). Once NEP legalised private grain trade (March 1921AD) and reopened light industry, Moscow vaulted past its pre-war peak to 1,54M (1923AD) and 2,03M (December 1926AD, governorate 4,18M), while Leningrad recovered to 1,07M (1923AD) and 1,61M (1926AD, governorate 2,69M) [12][32].

In the European North (Region 27, shifting from 2,28M to 2,13M and 2,39M), British-American-French intervention forces occupied Murmansk (Romanov-on-Murman) and Arkhangelsk (1918-1920AD),

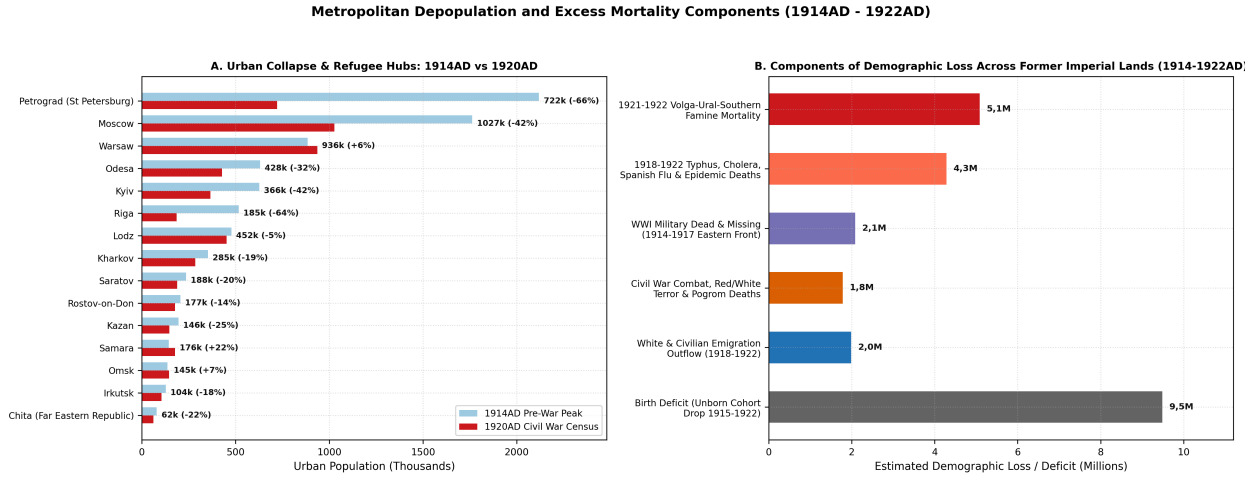


Figure 4. Population trajectories of the 22 largest cities across the pre-war Tsarist regions at the 1914AD, 1920AD and 1926AD benchmarks in thousands.

followed in August 1921AD by creation of the Komi (Zyryan) AO (Ust-Sysolsk). Across the Central Black-Earth Belt (Regions 30-31), Denikin's autumn 1919AD advance reached Kursk and Oryol (Region 30, 8,18M to 7,36M), while ruthless *prodrazvyorstka* grain requisitions in Tambov and Voronezh (Region 31, falling from 9,45M in 1917AD to 8,34M in 1922AD, -11,7%) ignited Aleksandr Antonov's 40.000-strong Antonovshchina peasant war (August 1920-summer 1921AD), suppressed by Mikhail Tukhachevsky with 100.000 Red troops, hostage concentration camps, village deportations and chemical shells [51][52][53] (archived PDF; archived PDF; archived PDF).

The Volga-Ural Famine and International Relief

The deadliest mortality crisis of the period struck the Volga-Kama-Ural basin (Regions 32-34 and 39-40, 1.442.819 km2) in 1921-1922AD. Three consecutive years of *prodrazvyorstka* requisitions stripped peasant seed reserves across Samara, Saratov, Simbirsk, Kazan and Ufa just before an extreme spring-summer 1921AD anticyclonic drought burned out 60-85% of the harvest, coinciding with 25M-30M Soviet-wide cases of louse-borne epidemic typhus and relapsing fever (2,5M-3M deaths across 1918-1922AD), 1921AD Volga cholera and 1918-1919AD Spanish influenza (~1,5M-2M deaths) [54][55][56][57][58] (archived PDF; archived PDF; archived PDF).

Along the Lower and Middle Volga steppe, Samara and Saratov Governorates (Region 33, including the Volga German Labour Commune and subsequent ASSR) contracted by -27,2% (7,12M in 1917AD to 6,58M in 1920AD to 5,18M in 1922AD, a loss of -1,94M), with rural Pugachyov and Buzuluk uezds and the Volga German colonies (Pokrovsk/Engels and Marxstadt, established as an autonomous commune in October 1918AD and ASSR in January 1924AD) suffering 25-35% population loss through starvation and flight before partial recovery to 6,02M in 1926AD [59][60] (archived PDF; archived PDF).

In the southern Urals, Ufa and Orenburg Governorates (Region 40, including the Bashkir ASSR) plunged by -27,7% (5,48M in 1917AD to 3,96M in 1922AD, a loss of -1,52M; 4,66M in 1926AD). Created in March 1919AD as the first Soviet autonomous republic (*Little Bashkiria*, expanded with Ufa Governorate into *Greater Bashkiria* in June 1922AD), rural Bashkir cantons experienced severe famine and typhus losses exceeding 25-30%, compounded by Ataman Aleksandr Dutov's 1918-1919AD Orenburg Cossack campaigns and the transfer of southern Orenburg steppe districts to the Kirghiz (Kazakh) ASSR [61][62][63][64] (archived PDF; archived PDF; archived PDF).

Across the adjacent river and forest-steppe provinces, the Middle Volga governorates of Nizhny Novgorod, Kazan, Simbirsk and Penza (Region 32, encompassing the May 1920AD Tatar ASSR and June 1920AD Chuvash AO) declined by -20,7% (8,55M to 6,78M, with heavy mortality in Tatar and Chuvash villages). To the south, Astrakhan and the November 1920AD Kalmyk AO (Region 34) fell by -25,5% (1,41M to 1,05M) [60][65] (archived PDF), while in the Northern Urals, Perm and Vyatka (Region 39, including the November 1920AD Votsk/Udmurt and Mari AOs and the theatre of Kolchak's 1919AD Perm offensive) fell by -15,9% (8,04M to 6,76M).

Following Maxim Gorky's July 1921AD international appeal and the August 1921AD Riga Agreement, Herbert Hoover's American Relief Administration (ARA), Fridtjof Nansen's International Committee, the American Friends Service Committee and Pomgol established soup kitchens and medical stations from Kazan to Orenburg and Odessa, feeding over 10,5M Soviet citizens daily at peak operation in August 1922AD and preventing several million additional deaths [66]. Table 3 compares demographic reconstructions of 1918-1922AD excess mortality across Soviet and post-Soviet scholarship (~5M excess deaths in the 1921-1922AD famine within 8M-10,5M total 1918-1922AD excess military, terror, epidemic and famine deaths, plus 1,5M-2M White and civilian emigrants) [1][3][5][10][11][55].

Demographic Study/ Reconstruction	Spatial Domain	1918-22 Excess Deaths	Key Finding
Volkov (1930) - TsSU Dynamic Reconstruction	USSR Interwar Borders	7M-8,5M	Documents 1920AD urban collapse & 5M 1921-22 famine toll
Lorimer (1946) - League of Nations USSR Balance	USSR 1926AD Territory	9M-10M (incl. deficit)	14M+ total deficit incl. birth losses & 2M out-migration
Wheatcroft (1981) - Mortality & 1921-22 Famine	USSR Famine & Epidemic Zones	5M (1921-22 Famine/ Typhus)	Isolates louse-borne typhus & Povolzhye-Ural harvest failure
Polyakov (1986) & Zhiromskaya-Polyakov (2000)	Soviet Territory (1917-1922AD)	8M-10M (+2M emigr.)	Integrates Civil War fronts, Red/White Terror & emigration
Maksudov (1989) - Demographic Losses of USSR	USSR Territory (1918-1922AD)	7,8M-9,5M (+2M emigr.)	Separates combat/terror (2,5M), typhus (3M) & famine (4-5M)
Andreev, Darsky & Kharkova (1993) - Goskomstat	RSFSR & USSR Back-Projection	8,5M-10,5M (1921-22: 5M)	Age-sex cohort back-projection from 1926AD All-Union Census
Present 48-Region Tsarist Reconstruction (1914-1926AD)	48 Pre-War Tsarist Regions	9,5M-10,8M (+Finn./ Border)	167,94M (1914) to 148,66M (1922) to 167,78M (1926)

Table 3. Comparative demographic estimates of excess mortality, famine losses and emigration (1918AD - 1922AD).

The Don, Kuban and North Caucasus

Across the Cossack and North Caucasian belt (Regions 35-38, 434.845 km2), Civil War fronts overlapped with Bolshevik decossackisation (*raskazachivanie*) and highland ethno-territorial restructuring [6][67][68] (archived PDF; archived PDF).

In the Don Cossack Host (Region 35, contracting by -21,6% from 3,94M to 3,09M) and the Kuban-Black Sea region (Region 36, falling by -20,2% from 3,12M to 2,49M), Kaledin and Krasnov's early Don campaigns were followed by the Orgburo's 24 January 1919AD circular ordering mass terror against upper-Don Cossack elites. That directive provoked the March-June 1919AD Veshenskaya Uprising, which was

followed in turn by the winter 1919-1920AD Don-Kuban retreat, the March 1920AD White evacuation from Novorossiysk, Cossack deportations and the 1921-1922AD Salsk-Kuban drought (with the Adygei [Cherkess] AO formed in July 1922AD).

Farther east across Stavropol and Terek Oblast (Region 37, declining by -16,2% from 2,65M to 2,22M) and Dagestan Oblast (Region 38, falling by -14,5% from 725k to 620k), fierce 1918-1920AD fighting pitted Terek Cossack *stanitsas* against Chechen and Ingush highlanders, including the August-November 1918AD Hundred Days Battle of Grozny. In spring-autumn 1920AD, Sergo Ordzhonikidze ordered the expulsion and deportation of 45.000-70.000 Terek Cossacks from Assinovskaya, Sernovodskaya, Ermolovskaya, Zakan-Yurtovskaya and Kalinovskaya *stanitsas* along the Sunzha line, transferring their lands to Vainakh highlanders and establishing the Mountain ASSR (20 January 1921AD, capital Vladikavkaz), which subsequently devolved (1921-1924AD) into the Kabardino-Balkar, Karachay-Cherkess, Chechen, North Ossetian and Ingush autonomous oblasts while Grozny boomed on NEP oil reconstruction (2k in 1914AD to 97,1k in 1926AD) [62]. Simultaneously in Dagestan (where the Dagestan ASSR was proclaimed on 20 January 1921AD and the capital shifted from Temir-Khan-Shura/Buynaksk to Petrovsk-Port/Makhachkala), Imam Najmuddin Gotsinsky and Kailasan Alikhanov led the September 1920-May 1921AD Avar-Andi mountain uprising across Gunib and Khunzakh before Red 11th Army suppression.

Siberia and the Far East

Across Siberia and the Far East (Regions 41-48, 12.854.849 km2), population held near or above pre-war levels (12,47M in 1914AD to 12,88M in 1917AD, 12,66M in 1920AD, 12,73M in 1922AD and 14,65M in 1926AD) because inward peasant flight from the starving Volga-Ural provinces offset localised military and epidemic mortality [7][10].

In Western and Central Siberia (Regions 41-45), the May 1918AD Czechoslovak Legion revolt along the Trans-Siberian trunk enabled Admiral Aleksandr Kolchak to establish his White Supreme Ruler government in Omsk (Region 41), swelling the city with ministries, officers and refugees from 148k (1917AD) to ~245k (summer 1919AD). When Tukhachevsky's 5th Red Army took Omsk in November 1919AD, General Vladimir Kappel led the winter 1919-1920AD Great Siberian Ice March (*Velikiy Sibirskiy Ledyanoy Pokhod*) 2.000 km eastward through -40C frosts across Novonikolaevsk (Region 43), Taiga, Achinsk, Krasnoyarsk, Kansk and frozen Lake Baikal to Irkutsk (Region 45, where Kolchak was executed in February 1920AD); raging railway-car typhus killed tens of thousands of soldiers and civilians at Novonikolaevsk (0k in 1919AD down to 67,2k in August 1920AD before leaping to 120,1k by 1926AD as Siberian krai capital) and Krasnoyarsk (0k to 60,8k) [7]. In February-June 1921AD, punitive grain requisitions in Ishim, Tobolsk, Kurgan and Tyumen provoked the 60.000-strong West Siberian Peasant Uprising, severing both Trans-Siberian rail lines for three weeks [69][70] (archived PDF; archived PDF). Meanwhile, Altai partisan strongholds (Barnaul and Biysk in Region 43) absorbed hundreds of thousands of famine migrants, while in the Altai-Sayan and Uriankhai highlands (Region 44) Moscow sponsored the August 1921AD Tannu-Tuva People's Republic (Kyzyl/Belotsarsk) alongside the June 1922AD Oyrot (Gorny Altai) AO and Khakass Okrug.

East of Lake Baikal (Regions 46-48), Lenin authorised the Far Eastern Republic (FER, 6 April 1920-15 November 1922AD, with its capital at Chita from October 1920AD) as a buffer state in Regions 47-48 to avoid direct war with 70.000 Japanese intervention troops while liquidating Ataman Grigory Semyonov in Transbaikalia and Baron Roman von Ungern-Sternberg along the Kyakhta-Mongolian frontier (where the Buryat-Mongol ASSR was established in May 1923AD) [71] (archived PDF). In Yakutia (Region 47, where the Yakut ASSR was proclaimed on 27 April 1922AD), the 1921-1923AD Yakut Revolt and White General Anatoly Pepelyaev's 1922-1923AD Okhotsk-Ayan-Amga expedition ended the last armed White campaign in Russia just before the 1924AD Aldan gold rush. In Priamurye and Sakhalin (Region 48), partisan commander Yakov Tryapitsyn burned Nikolaevsk-on-Amur in May 1920AD (4k down to 3,2k), provoking

Japanese occupation of Northern Sakhalin (1920-1925AD, returned under the January 1925AD Beijing Convention). Following the October 1922AD Spassk offensive, Japanese forces evacuated Vladivostok on 25 October 1922AD alongside Admiral Georgy Stark's 30-ship White flotilla (~10.000 evacuees to Wonsan and Shanghai) and tens of thousands of White emigres crossing into Harbin, Manchuria, after which the FER merged into the RSFSR (with Vladivostok stabilising from its 136k refugee peak in 1921AD to 108k in 1926AD) [72][73] (archived PDF; archived PDF).

Conclusion

Maintaining the forty-eight pre-war Tsarist Governorate and Oblast boundaries across 18.607.231 km2 (460.079 five-arcminute grid cells) preserves continuity across the 1914AD (167,94M) and 1917AD (165,38M) splice years while accounting for all 1918-1926AD secessions and internal boundary realignments in Table 2. The accompanying settlement gazetteer tracks 275 urban centres across all forty-eight regions (4-8 cities per region) through all nine benchmark years from 1914AD to 1926AD, drawing on 75 bibliographic sources and 40 archived primary and historiographical studies.

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